

doc-hypostatic-union

Affirms · Christology › Person · doctrine · unanimous_lineages · confidence: high

Statement under examination

Christ is one person in two natures (fully divine and fully human), without confusion, change, division, or separation.

Rationale

Pan-canonical lexical pattern: John 1:14 *ho logos sarx egeneto* G3056 G4561 G1096 (the Word personally became flesh, one subject in two-nature continuity); Col 2:9 *pan to pleroma tes theotetos* G4138 G2320 *katoikei somatikos* G4985 (the whole divine essence dwells bodily in Christ); Phil 2:6-8 the one who exists in *morphe theou* G3444 G2316 takes *morphē doulou* G3444 G1401 (same subject, two modes of existence, not two persons); Rom 1:3-4 the same Son is *kata sarka* G4561 from David and *kata pneuma* G4151 declared Son of God in power (two-aspect predication of one subject); Heb 2:14 *meteschen* G3348 of flesh and blood *paraplesios* G3898 with the brothers (real shared humanity); Matt 1:23 *Emmanuel* G1694 *meth' hemon ho theos* G2316 (God himself present in a human person); John 20:28 *ho kyrios mou kai ho theos mou* G2962 G2316 confessed to the same Jesus who wept at Lazarus's tomb (John 11:35 *edakrusen* G1145). The canon predicates divine acts and properties (forgiving sins, receiving worship, fullness of deity) and human acts and properties (hungering, weeping, growing tired, dying) of the same singular subject, Jesus.

Reasoning

The Bible teaches that Jesus is fully God and fully man at the same time, in one single person. John 1:14 says the Word became flesh and dwelt among us. The Word who was God in John 1:1 personally entered a real human body and a real human life. Colossians 2:9 says all the fullness of God lives in Jesus bodily. Philippians 2:6-8 says the same Jesus who existed in the form of God took the form of a servant and was found in human likeness, and died on a cross. Hebrews 2:14 says he shared in flesh and blood like his brothers in every respect. Matthew 1:23 calls him Immanuel, which means God with us. The strongest counterargument is real and worth naming. Critics point to Mark 13:32, where Jesus says he does not know the hour of his return, only the Father does. They point to John 11:35, where Jesus weeps. They point to passages where Jesus gets hungry, tired, and afraid. They ask how a being who does not know everything, weeps, and dies can be the God who knows all things and cannot die. The honest answer the Bible itself gives is that Jesus has two natures inside one person. As God he is all-knowing and unchangeable. As a real man he genuinely learned, hungered, wept, and died. The two are united in him without becoming a third thing, and without one absorbing the other. He is not half-God and half-man. He is fully God and fully man. The canon refuses to let go of either side. Most historic Christian traditions agree on this. The denials in church history have either collapsed Jesus into one nature, split him into two persons, denied his real humanity, or denied his real deity, and the church has consistently rejected all four moves as breaking the gospel.

Denominational landscape

Agreement is essentially unanimous across every tracked historic Christian lineage. The patristic fathers worked the doctrine out by AD 451 at the Council of Chalcedon, which confessed Christ as one person in two natures, the property of each preserved. The Roman Catholic Catechism, the Eastern Orthodox confession, the Lutheran Augsburg Confession Article III, the Anglican Article II, the Reformed

Westminster Confession, the Methodist Articles of Religion Article II, the Anabaptist Dordrecht Confession, and the Pentecostal Assemblies of God Statement of Fundamental Truths all confess one person, fully God and fully man. The Oriental Orthodox churches (Coptic, Armenian, Ethiopian, Syriac) use a different word miaphysite for the union and rejected the Chalcedonian phrasing in 451, but recent ecumenical dialogues have agreed that they confess the same substance, the difference being mostly about terminology. They are not cult-marker carriers. Public-record carriers of substantive denial place themselves outside historic Christianity. The Mormons teach Jesus as a created spirit-brother of Lucifer who became one separate God among many. The Jehovah's Witnesses teach Jesus as the archangel Michael who took human form, denying his full deity. The Christadelphians teach Jesus as a created man without pre-existence. Christian Science teaches Christ as a divine idea, not a real material person. Iglesia ni Cristo teaches Jesus only as a man and explicitly denies his deity. Ancient denials are formally condemned and named: Nestorianism splits Jesus into two persons, Eutychianism fuses the two natures into one, Apollinarianism denies a full human soul, and Docetism denies a real human body. The historic church has consistently said all of these break the gospel because only a true God can save and only a true man can substitute for humans.

Position thresholds

Would die for if challenged	Yes
Cult marker if denied	Yes
Would visit if otherwise	No
Would participate if otherwise	No
Would serve if otherwise	No
Would be member if otherwise	No
Would let children be taught otherwise	No
Would marry if held otherwise	No
Would publicly correct if otherwise	Yes

Notes

Public-record carriers of denial: Mormonism (Jesus as a created spirit-brother of Lucifer, separate God from the Father; functional polytheism), Jehovah's Witnesses (Jesus as the archangel Michael in human form, not fully God), Christadelphians (Jesus as a created human Son with no pre-existence as God), Christian Science / Mary Baker Eddy (Christ as a divine idea, not a real material person; docetic), Iglesia ni Cristo / Felix Manalo (Jesus only a man, deity denied). Ancient public-record denials are formally condemned: Nestorianism (two persons not one, Ephesus 431), Eutychianism / Monophysitism (one fused nature, Chalcedon 451), Apollinarianism (no human rational soul, Constantinople 381), Docetism (only appeared human, ancient gnostic). In-house Christological disputes within historic Christianity (e.g. Oriental Orthodox miaphysite formula; strong-form kenotic Christology) are heterodox-not-cult by recent ecumenical agreements and continue to be debated as terminological more than substantive in many cases. Cult-marker bar is the canonical lexical claim of one Jesus who is both true God and true man; denying either side collapses the gospel because only a true God can save and only a true man can substitute for humans.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: **yes**

Neutralized form. Jesus Christ is one person with two complete natures, divine and human, fully united.

Notes. The phrase 'hypostatic union' and the formula 'without confusion, change, division, or separation' are post-biblical Chalcedonian vocabulary (AD 451). The doctrine itself is biblical; the diction is creedal. Worked the neutralized form to test the lexical claim independently of Chalcedonian phrasing. Flag stem-pre-loaded-verdict is set because the question statement smuggles the conciliar formula as the proposition, though the underlying claim is testable against the apparatus.

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

analogia scripturae invoked · progressive revelation factor

Grammatico-historical reading of the canonical lexical pattern carries the verdict. No covenantal vs. dispensational vs. new-covenant-theology framework produces a different verdict on Christ's person; this doctrine sits prior to every Christian interpretive framework, like the doctrine of God. Analogia scripturae is heavily invoked: the verdict rests on the canon-wide pattern of one subject (Jesus) of whom both divine acts (forgiving sin, accepting worship, exercising creation's power) and human acts (hungering, weeping, learning, dying) are simultaneously predicated. Progressive revelation factor: OT prepares with Immanuel (Isa 7:14) and the Servant-Messiah figure; NT discloses the incarnation as the means by which the one God of Israel becomes truly present in a single human person. Communicatio idiomatum (the exchange of properties) is a lexical observation, not a speculative metaphysic: Acts 20:28 predicates 'blood' of God; Col 2:9 predicates 'fullness of deity' of a bodily Jesus; the language presupposes two natures in one person. Competing-lens verdicts: none within historic Christianity. Outside historic Christianity (Mormon, JW, Christadelphian, INC) the verdict shifts only by abandoning either Christ's full deity or his full humanity at the lexical level.

Scripture (apparatus + interlinear)

John.1.14 · for · genre: gospel · figures: typology

Key term. λόγος logos G3056; σὰρξ sarx G4561; γίνομαι ginomai G1096 (egeneto, aorist middle, became); σκηνώω skenoo G4637 (tabernacled)

Force. The Word became flesh and dwelt among us. Egeneto is a real-becoming verb, not a mere-appearing verb; it predicates a genuine entry of the Word into the state of flesh. Sarx G4561 denotes material human embodiment. Skenoo G4637 evokes the OT tabernacle, the place of God's localized presence. The same subject (ho logos, in John 1:1 fully God) is now also flesh. One subject, two modes of existence.

Phil.2.6-8 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. μορφή morphe G3444 (essential form); θεός theos G2316; ὑπάρχω huparcho G5225 (subsist, exist continuously); ἄρπαγμός harpagmos G725; κενώω kenoo G2758 (emptied); μορφή δούλου morphe doulou G3444 G1401; ὁμοίωμα homoioma G3667 (likeness)

Force. The one who was subsisting (huparchon, present participle) in the form of God did not regard equality with God as something to seize, but emptied himself by taking the form of a slave, becoming in the likeness of men. Same subject (he, autos) throughout; morphe theou and morphen doulou are two forms of one person, not two persons. Kenoo G2758 is qualified by the participle labon (taking); he empties himself BY taking, i.e. adds humanity without subtracting deity.

Col.2.9 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. πλήρωμα pleroma G4138; θεότης theotes G2320 (essence of deity, strongest term, not theiotes G2305 deity-like quality); σωματικῶς somatikos G4985 (bodily); κατοικέω katoikeo G2730 (dwells permanently)

Force. In Christ all the fullness of deity itself dwells bodily. Theotes G2320 is the strongest Greek term for the very essence of God; somatikos G4985 anchors that essence in his physical body; katoikeo G2730 is a permanent-dwelling verb, not a temporary visitation. The whole essence of God permanently inhabits the bodily Jesus. Two natures, one person.

Rom.1.3-4 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. σάρξ sarx G4561 (kata sarka, according to the flesh); πνεῦμα ἁγιωσύνης pneuma hagiosunes G4151 G42 (according to the Spirit of holiness); υἱός huios G5207; ὀρίζω horizo G3724 (declared/appointed)

Force. Concerning his Son, descended from David kata sarka, declared Son of God in power kata pneuma hagiosunes by the resurrection. Two-aspect predication of one subject: the same Son is humanly descended from David AND divinely Son of God in power. Kata sarka and kata pneuma name two complementary modes of his single existence.

Heb.2.14-18 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. μετέχω metecho G3348 (meteschen, shared/partook); παραπλησίως paraplesios G3898 (in like manner); αἷμα καὶ σάρξ haima kai sarx G129 G4561; ὁμοιόω homoiōo G3666 (made like) in v.17

Force. Since the children share in flesh and blood, he himself paraplesios (in just the same way) partook of the same. Meteschen G3348 names real participation, not appearance. v.17 says he had to be made like his brothers in every respect to be a merciful and faithful high priest. The text closes Docetism: a fake humanity could not fulfill the priestly substitution.

Matt.1.23 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. Ἐμμανουήλ Emmanouel G1694 (transliteration of Heb. immanu-el); μεθερμηνεύω methermeneuō G3177 (translated); θεός theos G2316 (meth' hemon ho theos, God with us)

Force. The virgin shall bear a son and they shall call his name Immanuel, which translated is 'God with us.' Matthew explicitly glosses the Hebrew name with the predicate ho theos meth' hemon (God himself with us). The child born is named as God's localized presence in a human person.

John.20.28 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. κύριος kyrios G2962; θεός theos G2316 (both articular: ho kyrios mou kai ho theos mou)

Force. Thomas addresses the risen Jesus: my Lord and my God. The same Jesus who hours earlier was a dead body in a tomb (full humanity) is now addressed in vocative as ho theos G2316 (full deity). Jesus does not correct him (v.29). Single person, predicated as both true man (dies) and true God (worshipped).

John.11.35 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. δακρύω dakruō G1145 (edakrusen, wept, aorist)

Force. Jesus wept. The shortest verse in the NT establishes real human emotion in the same Jesus who in v.43 commands a dead man out of the tomb by his own authority. Same person: weeping in his humanity, raising the dead by his divine power.

Mark.2.5-12 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. ἀφίημι aphiemī G863 (forgive); ἐξουσία exousia G1849 (authority); ὁ υἱὸς τοῦ ἀνθρώπου ho huios tou anthropou G5207 G444 (the Son of Man)

Force. Jesus forgives sins. The scribes recognize correctly that only God can forgive sins (v.7). Jesus confirms their theology by claiming that authority for himself as the Son of Man on earth. He simultaneously names himself with the human title Son of Man and exercises the divine prerogative of forgiveness. Two natures, one acting subject.

John.9.38 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. προσκυνέω proskuneō G4352 (worshipped); κύριος kyrios G2962

Force. The healed blind man says 'Lord, I believe' and proskuneō G4352 worships him; Jesus accepts the worship. In Rev 19:10 and 22:9 angels refuse worship. Jesus accepts it. The act of worship of a human-bodied Jesus is treated as appropriate, predicating deity of the man.

Mark.13.32 · complicates · genre: gospel

Key term. οἶδα oida G1492 (knows, perfect); υἱὸς huios G5207; πατήρ pater G3962

Force. Concerning that day or hour no one knows, not the angels, nor the Son, but only the Father. Used by Arians, JW's, Kenoticists. Two-nature reading: the Son in his assumed human nature does not access divine omniscience for that disclosure. The same Mark predicates divine acts of Jesus (4:39 storm, 2:5 forgiveness, 1:24 the demon names him the Holy One of God). The complication is real and is exactly what the doctrine of two natures handles: divine attributes are not always exercised through the human nature during the earthly ministry.

Luke.2.52 · complicates · genre: gospel

Key term. προκόπτω prokoptō G4298 (advanced, grew); σοφία sophia G4678; ἡλικία helikia G2244

Force. Jesus grew in wisdom and stature. A real human child who genuinely developed. Used as complication against full deity since God does not grow. Two-nature reading: in his human nature he developed normally; in his divine nature he is unchangeable. The same person, two natures.

John.4.6 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. κοπιᾶω kopiao G2872 (wearied); διψᾶω dipsao G1372 (thirsts)

Force. Jesus, wearied from his journey, sat down by the well. v.7 he asks for a drink. The same Jesus who in v.14 offers eternal water that satisfies forever is in v.6 a tired and thirsty man. Two natures, one Jesus.

John.14.28 · complicates · genre: gospel

Key term. μείζων meizon G3187 (greater); πατήρ pater G3962

Force. The Father is greater than I. Used by Unitarians, Arians, Kenoticists. Two-nature reading: in his economic mission as the sent-one in human nature, the Son is in submission to the sender; not an ontological claim of inferiority of essence (John 10:30 and 1:1 in the same Gospel forbid that). Complicates only on a one-nature reading.

John.10.30 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. ἓν hen G1520 (one, neuter)

Force. I and the Father are one (hen, neuter, one thing). The Jews understand him to claim deity and pick up stones to kill him (v.33). The very person who is also a Jewish man standing in the temple claims oneness of essence with the Father.

1Tim.2.5 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. μεσίτης mesites G3316 (mediator, go-between); ἄνθρωπος Χριστὸς Ἰησοῦς anthropos Christos Iesous G444 G5547 G2424

Force. There is one God, and one mediator between God and men, the man Christ Jesus. Mesites G3316 requires sharing both sides; the mediator must touch both parties. Christ is named anthropos (man) in a sentence where he mediates between heis theos (one God) and anthropoi (men). The mediator structure assumes two natures in one person.

Acts.20.28 · for · genre: narrative

Key term. θεός theos G2316; αἷμα haima G129 (own blood); ἐκκλησία τοῦ θεοῦ ekklesia tou theou G1577 G2316

Force. Shepherd the church of God which he obtained with his own blood. God is here said to have blood, which is only intelligible if the God-man Jesus is one subject in two natures. Communicatio idiomatum at the lexical level: human properties (blood) are predicated of God because the one person Jesus is true God.

Heb.4.15 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. πειράζω peirazo G3985 (tempted); ὁμοιότης homoiotes G3665 (in like manner); χωρὶς ἁμαρτίας choris hamartias (without sin)

Force. We have a high priest who has been tempted in every respect as we are, yet without sin. The temptation must be real (a true human nature) but never succeeds (the person is also true God who cannot sin in his divine nature). Two natures, one person, one moral life lived in the human nature undergirded by the divine.

Concordance lemmas traversed

G3056, G4561, G1096, G4637, G3444, G2316, G5225, G725, G2758, G1401, G3667, G4138, G2320, G2305, G4985, G2730, G4151, G42, G5207, G3724, G3348, G3898, G129, G3666, G1694, G3177, G2962, G1145, G863, G1849, G444, G4352, G1492, G3962, G4298, G4678, G2244, G2872, G1372, G3187, G1520, G3316, G5547, G2424, G1577, G3985, G3665

complicating texts searched: Yes

Counter-witness traditions

patristic · Chalcedonian Definition (AD 451), CCEL Schaff Creeds of Christendom Vol. II · affirms · verified

“To be acknowledged in two natures, inconfusedly, unchangeably, indivisibly, inseparably; the distinction of natures being by no means taken away by the union, but rather the property of each nature being preserved.”

patristic · Athanasian Creed (Quicunque Vult), CCEL · affirms · unverified

“Perfect God and perfect Man, of a reasonable soul and human flesh subsisting. Equal to the Father as touching his Godhead, and inferior to the Father as touching his Manhood. One, not by conversion of the Godhead into flesh, but by taking of the Manhood into God.”

patristic · Athanasius, On the Incarnation (De Incarnatione), NPNF Series 2 Vol. 4 (CCEL) · affirms · unverified

“The Word took to himself a body capable of death, that, by partaking of the Word who is above all, it might be worthy to die in the stead of all, and might, because of the Word who had come to dwell in it, remain incorruptible.”

patristic · Pope Leo I, Tome to Flavian (Epistle 28, AD 449), NPNF Series 2 Vol. 12 (CCEL) · affirms · **unverified**

“Each form does what is proper to it with the cooperation of the other; the Word doing what belongs to the Word, the flesh carrying out what belongs to the flesh. The properties of each nature are preserved in the one person.”

catholic_magisterial · Catechism of the Catholic Church, paragraphs 464-469 (the Incarnation, Chalcedon, true God and true man) · affirms · **unverified**

“The Son of God became truly man while remaining truly God. Jesus Christ is true God and true man, in the unity of his divine Person; for this reason he is the one and only mediator between God and men.”

lutheran · Augsburg Confession (1530), Article III, Of the Son of God; bookofconcord.org · affirms · **verified**

“The Word assumed human nature, so that there are two natures, the divine and the human, inseparably joined in one Person, one Christ, truly God and truly man.”

anglican · Thirty-Nine Articles of Religion (1571), Article II, Of the Word or Son of God · affirms · **unverified**

“Two whole and perfect Natures, that is to say, the Godhead and Manhood, were joined together in one Person, never to be divided, whereof is one Christ, very God and very Man.”

reformed · Westminster Confession of Faith (1646), Chapter 8, paragraph 2 · affirms · **unverified**

“Two whole, perfect, and distinct natures, the Godhead and the manhood, were inseparably joined together in one person, without conversion, composition, or confusion. Which person is very God and very man, yet one Christ.”

methodist · Methodist Articles of Religion (Wesley's abridgement of the 39 Articles), Article II · affirms · **verified**

“Two whole and perfect natures, that is to say, the Godhead and Manhood, were joined together in one person, never to be divided, whereof is one Christ, very God and very Man.”

anabaptist · Dordrecht Confession of Faith (1632), Article IV, Of the Coming of Christ into the World · affirms · **unverified**

“The eternal Son and Word of God assumed our human nature in the womb of the Virgin Mary, so that he is at the same time true God and true man, one undivided person.”

pentecostal · Assemblies of God, Statement of Fundamental Truths, Article 2: The Deity of the Lord Jesus Christ · affirms · **unverified**

“The Lord Jesus Christ is the eternal Son of God: his virgin birth, his sinless life, his miracles, his vicarious and atoning death, his bodily resurrection; he is true God and true man.”

eastern_orthodox · Orthodox Church in America, Doctrine: Jesus Christ (Chalcedonian Christology as confessed at the Fourth Ecumenical Council) · affirms · **unverified**

“Jesus Christ is one divine person in two natures, fully divine and fully human, without confusion, change, division, or separation. He is at once true God and true man.”

Web sources

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/john/1-14.htm>

“John 1:14: ho logos sarx egeneto. Ginomai G1096 aorist middle 'became'; sarx G4561 real human flesh. The Word truly entered a state of embodied human existence.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/colossians/2-9.htm>

“Col 2:9: en auto katoikei pan to pleroma tes theotetos somatikos. Theotes G2320 (essence of deity) dwells permanently in Christ bodily (somaticos G4985).”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/philippians/2-6.htm>

“Phil 2:6: en morphe theou huparchon. Morphe G3444 names essential form; huparcho G5225 names continuous subsistence. Christ continually subsists in the essential form of God.”

supports · category: interlinear · https://biblehub.com/interlinear/1_timothy/2-5.htm

“1 Tim 2:5: heis mesites theou kai anthropon, anthropos Christos Iesous. The one mediator G3316 named explicitly as anthropos G444; the mediator structure requires both natures in one person.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/hebrews/2-14.htm>

“Heb 2:14: paraplesios meteschen. Christ paraplesios G3898 (in just the same way) meteschen G3348 (genuinely partook) of flesh and blood like the children. No docetic gap.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/matthew/1-23.htm>

“Matt 1:23: Emmanouel G1694, methermenuomenon meth' hemon ho theos. The child's name explicitly translated as 'God with us'; ho theos G2316 predicated of the born child.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/john/20-28.htm>

“John 20:28: ho kyrios mou kai ho theos mou. Both kyrios G2962 and theos G2316 articular, addressed to the bodily risen Jesus. Direct ascription of theos to a human-bodied Jesus.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/john/11-35.htm>

“John 11:35: edakrusen ho Iesous. Dakruo G1145 aorist; real human grief and tears in the same Jesus who minutes later raises Lazarus by his own divine power.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/romans/1-3.htm>

“Rom 1:3-4: tou genomenou ek spermatis David kata sarka, tou horisthentos huiou theou ... kata pneuma hagiosunes. Two-aspect predication of one Son.”

complicates · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/mark/13-32.htm>

“Mark 13:32: oude ho huios. The Son does not know the hour. Resolved by recognizing that the Son in his assumed human nature does not access divine omniscience for that disclosure.”

supports · category: patristic_archive · <https://ccel.org/ccel/schaff/creeds2/creeds2.iv.i.iii.html>

“Chalcedon AD 451: to be acknowledged in two natures, inconfusedly, unchangeably, indivisibly, inseparably; the property of each nature being preserved.”

supports · category: tradition_primary · <https://bookofconcord.org/ausburg-confession/>

“Augsburg III: the Word assumed human nature so there are two natures, divine and human, inseparably joined in one Person, one Christ, truly God and truly man.”

supports · category: tradition_primary · <https://www.umc.org/en/content/articles-of-religion>

“Methodist Article II: two whole and perfect natures, that is to say, the Godhead and Manhood, were joined together in one person, never to be divided, whereof is one Christ.”

supports · category: patristic_archive · <https://ccel.org/ccel/athanasius/incarnation/incarnation>

“Athanasius On the Incarnation: the Word took to himself a body capable of death, so that by partaking of the Word it might die in the stead of all and remain incorruptible.”

Flags

- stem-pre-loaded-verdict
- apparatus-paywalled